

Supported by a large community, FreeBSD is continuously upgraded with new releases. Some users are on the lookout for the versions released officially, while some prefer keeping their software updated with the latest software releases. It can happen that even officially released versions may not have critical security fixes. In such a case, it becomes essential to upgrade to the latest versions. Using FreeBSD, you have all the tools to keep your system updated. You can easily upgrade to provide for better security of your system.

The software comes with a `FreeBSD-update` tool to make the experience a little less complicated. Upgrades from one version of FreeBSD to another with the same main version, such as from FreeBSD 10 to FreeBSD 10.1, are called minor version upgrades. Major version upgrades occur when FreeBSD is upgraded from one major version to another, such as like from FreeBSD 10.X to FreeBSD 11.X. You can install both types by issuing the `FreeBSD-update` command with a release version target.

Config file for the update

By default, the config file for the `FreeBSD-update` can work as-is. Any default settings can be modified at `/etc/FreeBSD-update.conf`

As you go through the comments in the file, you can understand the available options.

```
# Base system components which are required to be kept up-to-date.
Components world kernel
```

It is the particular parameter that controls how the parts of the FreeBSD are updated. Individual components may be specified, which include `src/base` or `src/sys`. However, an option will be to leave it as it is. This may result in problems as there is no proper sync with binaries and source code.

```
# Path starting with a statement in IgnorePaths
# the statement will be omitted
IgnorePaths /boot/kernel/linker.hints
```

To prevent any updating of directories such as `/bin` or `/sbin`, you can add their mentioned paths in the statement. The option can prevent the update from overdoing any modifications made.